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# Sources of Variation in India's Foreign Exchange Reserves during April-December 2025

Today, the Reserve Bank of India released the balance of payments (BoP) data for the third quarter (Q3), *i.e.*, October-December of 2025-26, on its website (www.rbi.org.in). On the basis of these data, the sources of variation in foreign exchange reserves during April-December 2025 are detailed below in Table 1.

**Table 1: Sources of Variation in Foreign Exchange Reserves***

(US$ billion)

| Items | | | April-December 2024 | April-December 2025 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I.** | | **Current Account Balance** | **-36.7** | **-30.2** |
| **II.** | | **Capital Account (net) (a to f)** | **22.9** | **-0.6** |
| | a. | Foreign Investment (i+ii) | 10.0 | -1.3 |
| | | (i) Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) | 0.6 | 3.0 |
| | | (ii) Portfolio Investment | 9.4 | -4.3 |
| | b. | Banking Capital | -0.8 | 1.0 |
| | | *of which:* NRI Deposits | 13.3 | 11.1 |
| | c. | Short-term Credit | 11.6 | 15.3 |
| | d. | External Assistance | 4.2 | 1.0 |
| | e. | External Commercial Borrowings | 7.9 | 6.7 |
| | f. | Other Items in Capital Account | -10.0 | -23.4 |
| **III.** | | **Valuation Change** | **3.1** | **50.2** |
| **IV.** | | **Total (I+II+III) @**<br>Increase in reserves (+) / Decrease in reserves (-) | **-10.7** | **19.4** |

*: Based on the old format of BoP which may differ from the new format (BPM6) in the treatment of transfers under the current account and ADRs/ GDRs under portfolio investment.

@: Difference, if any, is due to rounding off.

**Note**: 'Other Items in Capital Account' apart from 'Errors and Omissions' includes SDR allocation, leads and lags in exports/imports, funds held abroad, advances received pending issue of shares under FDI, capital receipts not included elsewhere, and rupee denominated debt.

On a balance of payments basis (*i.e.*, excluding valuation effects), foreign exchange reserves decreased by US$ 30.8 billion during April-December 2025 as compared to a depletion of US$ 13.8 billion during April-December 2024. Foreign

exchange reserves in nominal terms (*i.e.*, including valuation effects) increased by US$ 19.4 billion during April-December 2025 as against a depletion of US$ 10.7 billion in April-December 2024 (Table 2).

**Table 2: Comparative Position of Variation in Reserves**

(US$ billion)

| | Items | April-December 2024 | April-December 2025 |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | Change in Foreign Exchange Reserves (*i.e.*, Including Valuation Effects) | -10.7 | 19.4 |
| 2. | Valuation Effects [Gain (+)/Loss (-)] | 3.1 | 50.2 |
| 3. | Change in Foreign Exchange Reserves on BoP basis (*i.e.*, Excluding Valuation Effects) | -13.8 | -30.8 |

**Note**: Increase in reserves (+)/Decrease in reserves (-).
Difference, if any, is due to rounding off.

The valuation gain, primarily reflecting higher price of gold, depreciation of US dollar against major currencies and lower bond yields, increased to US$ 50.2 billion during April-December 2025 from US$ 3.1 billion during April-December 2024.

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